ORANGE
ENGLISH

FREE PRACTICE PACK

IELTS Writing Task 1: Introductions and Overviews

Ten charts, with the support fading as you go.

By Lindsey, former IELTS examiner and founder of Orange English

START HERE

How to use this pack

If Task 1 takes you a long time, you don't always need to practise a complete response. Working on introductions and overviews separately helps the language feel familiar, so you spend less time wondering how to begin.

The three steps

Charts	What you do
1 to 4	Fill the gaps, using the word boxes.
5 to 7	Write your own, using a sentence starter.
8 to 10	Write both on your own.

Take your time

Don't time yourself yet. Take as long as you need, and check each one before you move on. When this feels comfortable, write complete responses, and then work towards the recommended 20 minutes.

Check every introduction

- [ ] Have I paraphrased the prompt accurately?
- [ ] Have I avoided "the chart below"? "The chart compares…" is enough.
- [ ] Does my verb fit what the chart shows?

Check every overview

- [ ] Have I given the main message, without listing figures?
- [ ] Have I chosen comparisons that mean something?
- [ ] Have I checked the dates before choosing my tense? Past dates usually need past tenses. With no dates, the present simple is often appropriate.

Notice what you repeat

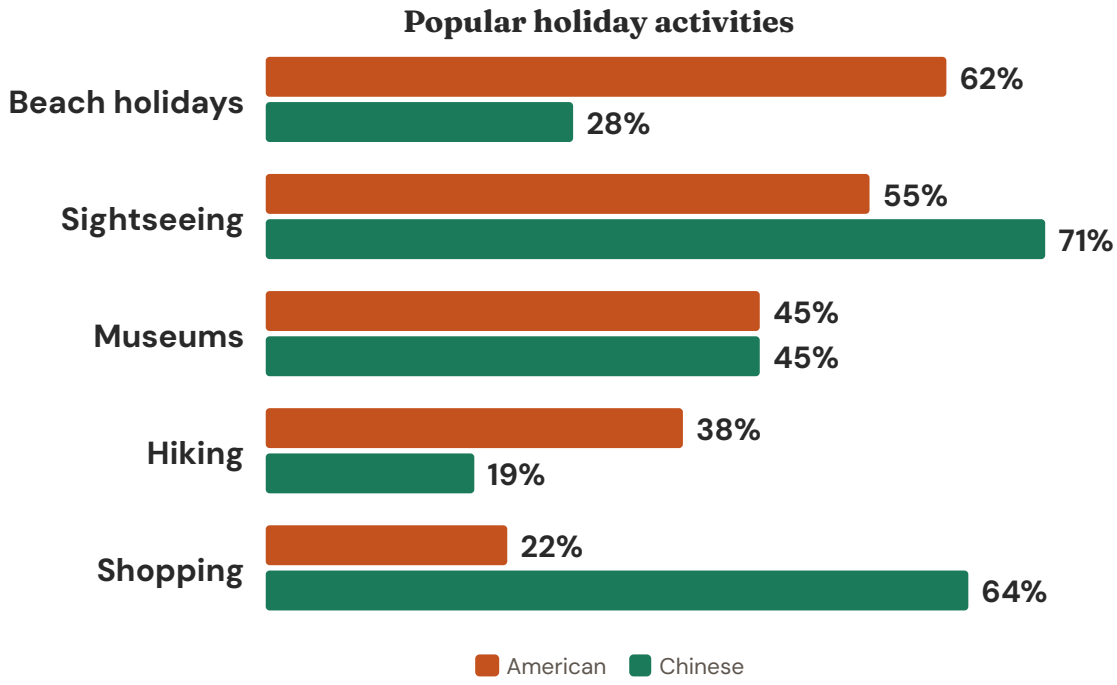
Compare your writing with the answers at the back. They're possible answers, not the only correct ones. Write down any errors you keep making, such as prepositions, tenses or articles.

All charts and figures in this pack are fictional and were created for practice.

STEP 1 · FILL THE GAPS

1. Holiday activities

The task: The chart shows the percentage of American and Chinese respondents who choose five holiday activities. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

Word box: compares / proportion / select

The bar chart (1) _____ the (2) _____ of people from the USA and China who (3) _____ five different holiday activities.

Overview

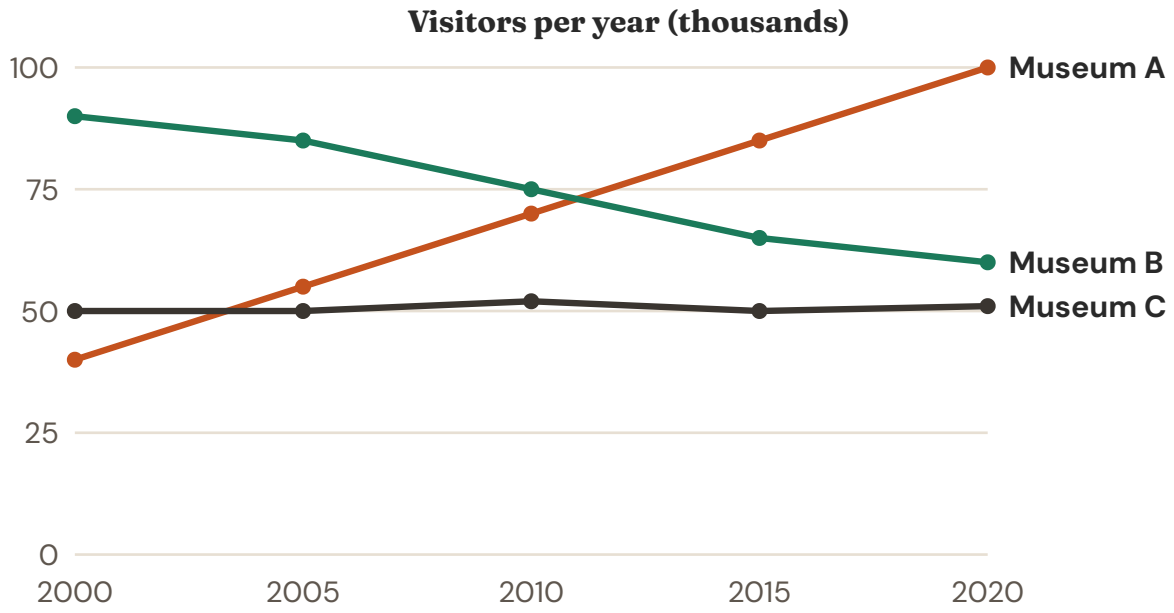
Word box: beach holidays / hiking / least / museums / sightseeing

Overall, (1) _____ are the most popular choice among American respondents, whereas (2) _____ is the favourite among Chinese respondents. The (3) _____ popular activity is shopping for Americans and (4) _____ for Chinese respondents, while (5) _____ attract the same proportion of both groups.

STEP 1 · FILL THE GAPS

2. Museum visitors

The task: The graph shows the number of visitors to three museums in one city between 2000 and 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

Word box: annual / between / illustrates

The line graph (1) _____ changes in the (2) _____ number of visitors to three city museums (3) _____ 2000 and 2020.

Overview

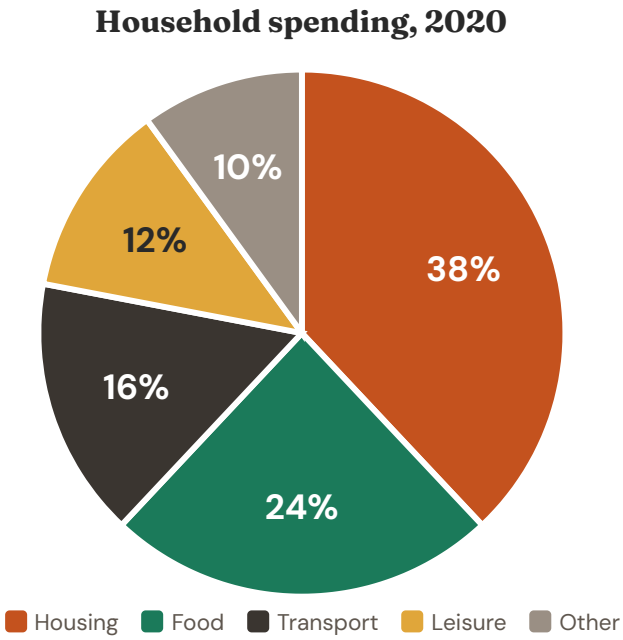
Word box: fell / highest / rose / stable

Overall, visitor numbers at Museum A (1) _____ considerably, while those at Museum B (2) _____. Museum C remained relatively (3) _____, and by 2020 Museum A had the (4) _____ figure of the three.

STEP 1 · FILL THE GAPS

3. Household spending

The task: The chart shows how an average household in one country spent its money in 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

Word box: breakdown / household / in

The pie chart gives a (1) _____ of average (2) _____ spending in one country (3) _____ 2020.

Overview

Word box: combined / food / housing / largest

Overall, (1) _____ was the (2) _____ area of spending, followed by (3) _____. These two categories (4) _____ made up more than half of the total.

STEP 1 · FILL THE GAPS

4. How students spend their time

The task: The table shows the average number of hours students in three countries spent on different activities each week in 2022. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Average weekly hours, 2022

	Japan	Brazil	Sweden
Studying	30	22	20
Paid work	4	10	8
Sport	3	6	7

Introduction

Word box: average / how / table

The (1) _____ shows (2) _____ students in three countries divided their week in 2022, giving the (3) _____ hours for each activity.

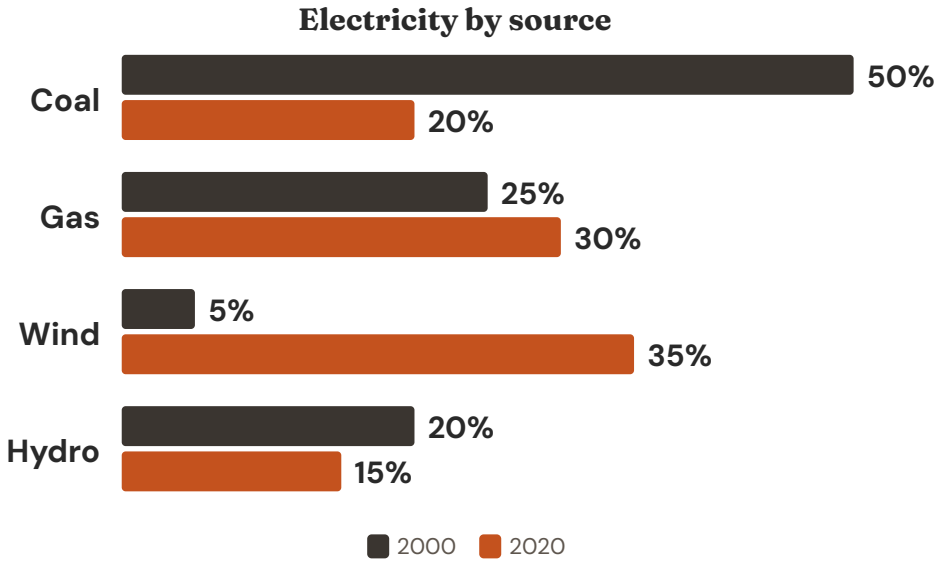
Overview

Word box: Brazilian / Japanese / most / studying

Overall, (1) _____ took up the most time in all three countries. (2) _____ students studied the (3) _____, while (4) _____ students spent the longest in paid work.

5. Sources of electricity

The task: The chart shows the percentage of electricity generated from four sources in one country in 2000 and 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

The bar chart compares…

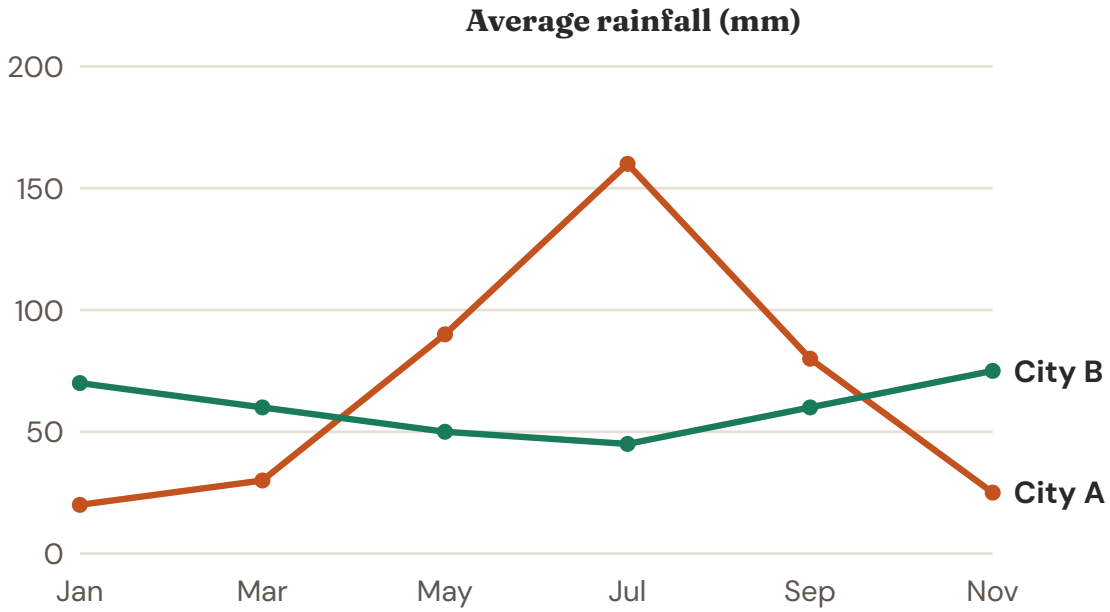
Overview

Overall, the most striking change is…

STEP 2 · USE THE SENTENCE STARTERS

6. Rainfall in two cities

The task: The graph shows average monthly rainfall in two cities. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

The line graph illustrates…

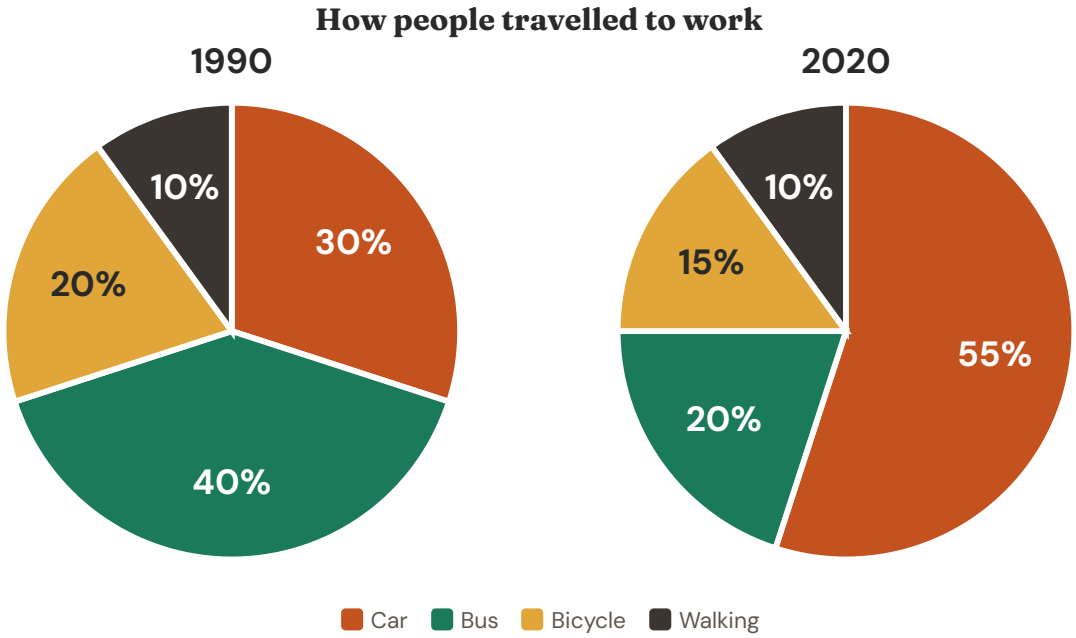
Overview

There are no years on this graph. Which tense will you use?

Overall, City A has…, whereas City B…

7. Travelling to work

The task: The charts show how people in one city travelled to work in 1990 and 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

The pie charts compare…

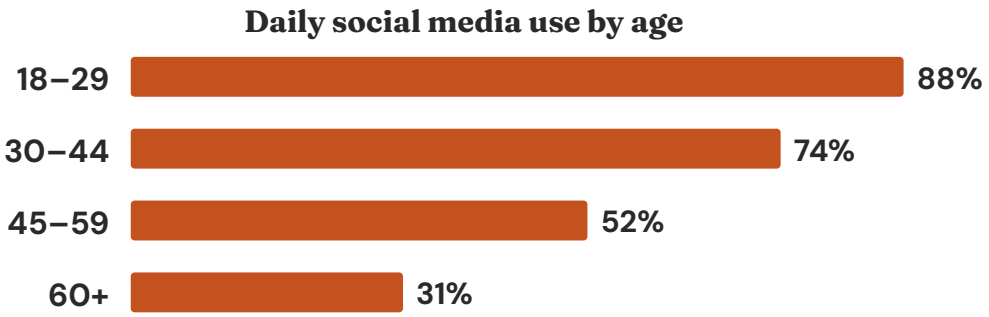
Overview

Overall, the car became…

STEP 3 · WRITE IT YOURSELF

8. Social media use

The task: The chart shows the percentage of people in four age groups who use social media every day. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

Overview

9. Quarterly sales

The task: The table shows sales of three products at one company in each quarter of 2023 (thousands of units). Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Sales in 2023 (thousands)

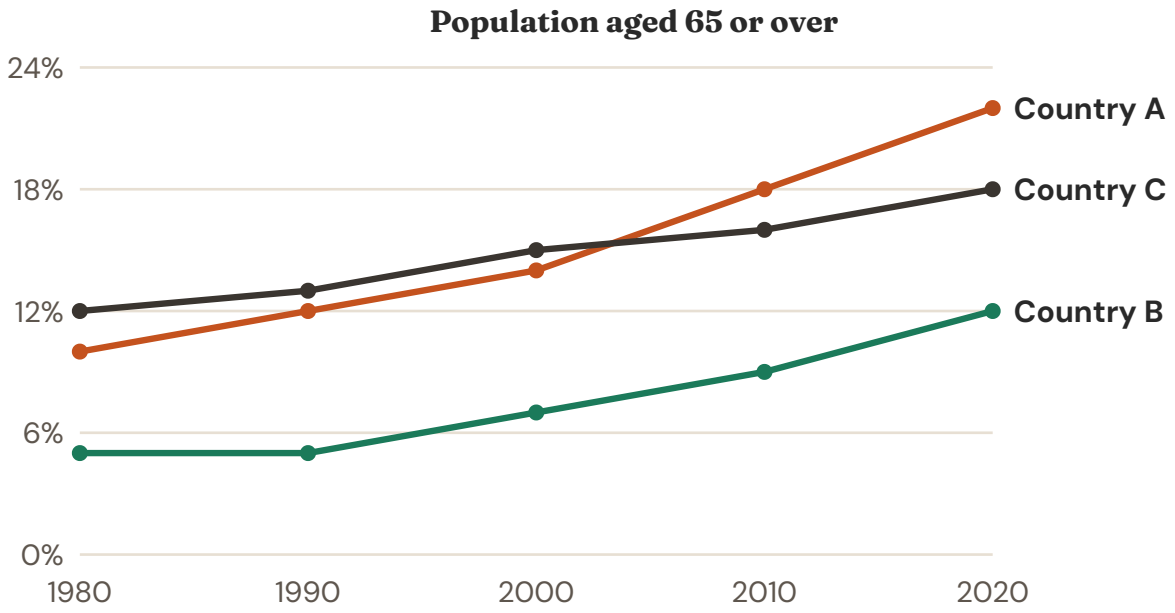
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Phones	70	72	71	73
Laptops	40	42	45	60
Tablets	30	28	25	22

Introduction

Overview

10. An ageing population

The task: The graph shows the percentage of the population aged 65 or over in three countries between 1980 and 2020. Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Introduction

Overview

Answers

1. Holiday activities

Introduction: The bar chart compares the proportion of people from the USA and China who select five different holiday activities.
Overview: Overall, beach holidays are the most popular choice among American respondents, whereas sightseeing is the favourite among Chinese respondents. The least popular activity is shopping for Americans and hiking for Chinese respondents, while museums attract the same proportion of both groups.

2. Museum visitors

Introduction: The line graph illustrates changes in the annual number of visitors to three city museums between 2000 and 2020.
Overview: Overall, visitor numbers at Museum A rose considerably, while those at Museum B fell. Museum C remained relatively stable, and by 2020 Museum A had the highest figure of the three.

3. Household spending

Introduction: The pie chart gives a breakdown of average household spending in one country in 2020.
Overview: Overall, housing was the largest area of spending, followed by food. These two categories combined made up more than half of the total.

4. How students spend their time

Introduction: The table shows how students in three countries divided their week in 2022, giving the average hours for each activity.
Overview: Overall, studying took up the most time in all three countries. Japanese students studied the most, while Brazilian students spent the longest in paid work.

5. Sources of electricity

Introduction: The bar chart compares the share of electricity produced from four sources in one country in 2000 and 2020.
Overview: Overall, the most striking change is the sharp fall in coal, which was replaced by wind as the largest source by 2020.

6. Rainfall in two cities

Introduction: The line graph illustrates average monthly rainfall in two cities over the course of a year.
Overview: Overall, City A has a very wet period peaking in July, whereas City B receives fairly steady rainfall throughout the year.

CHECK YOUR WORK

Answers, continued

From chart 5 onwards, these are possible answers. Yours can be different and still be good.

7. Travelling to work

Introduction: The pie charts compare the ways in which people in one city travelled to work in 1990 and 2020.
Overview: Overall, the car became the main way of getting to work, while the share of people using the bus fell. Walking was the only method that did not change.

8. Social media use

Introduction: The bar chart shows the proportion of people in four age groups who use social media daily.
Overview: Overall, daily use of social media falls with age, with the youngest group the most likely to use it and the oldest the least likely.

9. Quarterly sales

Introduction: The table gives quarterly sales figures for three products at one company in 2023.
Overview: Overall, phones were the best-selling product throughout the year, with fairly stable sales. Laptop sales rose, particularly at the end of the year, while tablet sales declined.

10. An ageing population

Introduction: The line graph shows how the proportion of people aged 65 or over changed in three countries between 1980 and 2020.
Overview: Overall, the proportion of older people rose in all three countries. Country A saw the largest increase and overtook Country C to finish with the highest figure, while Country B remained the lowest throughout.

WHAT NEXT?

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